

Church History





About the Course

Students read about important events and influential people from Church History using biographies and narrative-driven overviews of the time period. In this course, students delve into the 19th century and learn the stories of a variety of Christians.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grades 7-8, Bible: Grade 9



Placement & Combining Tips

Can be combined with Grades 5-6.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-9	Church History: Grades 7-9 1 time/week 30 min	Spurgeon: A Biography Renewal: The Church That Expands Outward An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 7-8				
Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 7-8	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8
Bible: Grade 9				
Bible History: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Church History: Grades 7-9



Spurgeon: A Biography



Renewal: The Church That Expands Outward



An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Church History: Grades 7-9

∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Church History: Grades 7-9

How To Teach



Prepare

Read the commentary to prepare.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)



Introduce

Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

Read aloud from the Bible.



Narrate

Have the students narrate.



Share

Optional: Share something interesting from your preparation that will help shed light on the story.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made.

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 1

William Wilberforce

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

1. This year, we are learning about people who lived during the 19th century (1800-1900). We will read how these Christians lived out Jesus' commands. When Jesus was asked what the greatest command was, he replied, "You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind. This is the great and first commandment. And a second is like it: You shall love your neighbor as yourself." (Matthew 22:37-39)

2. Today, you will read about an Englishman named William Wilberforce (1759-1833) who was a member of Parliament, the lawmaking group in the government of Great Britain. Parliament consisted of two houses: the House of Lords and the House of Commons. The English had been part of the slave trade since 1662. In 1770, out of a total of one hundred thousand slaves a year from West Africa, British ships transported more than half. English considered the slave trade inseparably linked with the commerce and national security of Great Britain.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Painting of William Wilberforce

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.93-100 "The striking of" - "after this event."

• Wilberforce had considered withdrawing from public life for the sake of his faith. However, his pastor John Newton advised him, "It is hoped and believed that the Lord has raised you up for the good of his church and for the good of the nation." What do you think about that advice?

• IMPORTANT DATES

1759-1833 - William Wilberforce
1833 - Slave Trade was abolished in England

• DEFINITIONS

diminutive: (p.93) small size

• EXTRA HELPING

You can listen to the hymn Amazing Grace and follow along with the lyrics on p.100.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace

WEEK 2 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 2

Fact Files: The Beacons of Freedom and Justice

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

Give a brief account of what you remember about William Wilberforce.

→ INTRO

In this section, "The Beacons of Freedom and Justice," you will be introduced to four historical figures who were motivated by their Christian faith to help others find freedom and justice. The first person lived in the 1700's, so that is the century before the time period we are studying this year.

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

1. p.101-102 "Freedom is a word" - "should be applauded."

2. Watch this video that tells about Oglethorpe's role in the founding of Georgia and then takes us up to the 19th century.

∞ Video Link: Founding of Georgia Colony

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

1. p.102-104 "Another Englishman who" - "Thee Are Spoken."

2. p.104-107 "While men like" - "fight for themselves."

3. Read this article to learn more about Harriet Tubman.

∞ Article Link: Black Moses

• IMPORTANT DATES

1733 - James Oglethorpe founds the colony of Georgia
1772 - John Newton pens Amazing Grace
1839 - Frederick Douglas becomes a licensed preacher
1850-1860 - Harriet Tubman's Underground Railroad Work

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Learn more about John Newton, the author of Amazing Grace

∞ Article Link: The Story of John Newton

∞ Video Link: Newton's Grace: The True Story of Amazing Grace

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 3

Emilie Mallet

 Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

What do you remember about our last reading?

→ INTRO

Today, you will read about a French lady from the 1800s who may be unknown to you but has an interesting story of love and service to those in need. She could have just enjoyed her upper-class lifestyle but wanted to show the love of Christ to others.

→ VIEW

1. ∞ Image Link: Emilie Mallet
2. The Pantheon in Paris (not to be confused with the Pantheon in Rome) is mentioned in this chapter. It is a mausoleum or monument that houses the remains of distinguished French citizens,
∞ Image Link: Pantheon in Paris

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.109-117 "The shrieks could" - "margins of society."
2. Read these excerpts from the biography *A Christian woman; being the life of Mme. Jules Mallet*, translated by Mrs. H.N. Goodhart. Most of them are journal entries from Emilie about the circumstances in Paris.
∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from *A Christian Woman*

- What did you learn about Emilie from her journal entries?

→ VIEW

Have you seen Toile de Jouy fabric before? It is actually French for "cloth from Jouy." It was produced by Emilie's father and can still be found today on decorative fabrics and wallpaper.
∞ Image Link: Toile de Jouy

• DEFINITIONS

cholera: (p.109) a disease that is caused by bacteria through water or food that has been tainted. Cholera can cause serious diarrhea and dehydration and can be fatal.

aristocracy: (p.111) upper class usually made up of a hereditary nobility

• IMPORTANT DATES

1832 - Emilie Mallet begins her charity work for young children and prisoners

WEEK 4 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 4

Sojourner Truth

 Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

Note: We are skipping the chapter on Charles Spurgeon since we are reading a whole book about him starting in Term 2.

→ RECAP

Who did you read about last week?

→ INTRO

Isabella Baumfree was born a slave to a Dutch master in New York c.1797. At age 46 or 47, she had a vision of God telling her to "travel up an' down the land showin' the people their sins an' bein' a sign unto them." This she did, with a new name that defined her mission—Sojourner Truth. She never learned to read or write but boldly spread a message of freedom for Blacks and women, as you will read about in this chapter.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.127-133 "The crowd outside" - "that historic building."
2. Read the excerpt "Her Escape" from her memoir p.41.
∞ Link: The Narrative of Sojourner Truth

→ VIEW

The bronze bust of abolitionist and women's rights advocate Sojourner

• IMPORTANT DATES

1851 - Sojourner Truth addresses the Ohio Women's Rights Convention

Church History: Grades 7-9

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Truth is the first sculpture to honor an African American woman in the United States Capitol.

∞ Image Link: Bronze bust of Sojourner Truth

WEEK 5 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 5

Robert Moffat

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

"Robert Moffat is sometimes regarded as the patriarch of South African missions, a man who had a significant influence in that region for more than half a century. Yet even during his own lifetime, he was overshadowed by his famous son-in-law, often being referred to as 'the father-in-law of David Livingstone.' Moffat, nevertheless, was the far greater missionary of the two. He was an evangelist, a translator, an educator, a diplomat, and an explorer, and he effectively combined those roles to become one of the truly great missionaries to Africa." (Ruth Tucker, From Jerusalem to Irian Jaya)

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of Robert Moffat

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.135-141 "The setting sun" - "of Jesus Christ."
 2. This short excerpt from the biography Robert Moffat: Pioneer in Africa by Cecil Northcott talks about the difficulties and joys of translating the Bible into the Tswana (also known as Setswana) language.
- ∞ PDF Link: Excerpt from Moffat biography

• DEFINITIONS

bairns: (p.136) Scottish term for child

catechism: (p.141) a summary of religious doctrine often in the form of questions and answers

• EXTRA HELPING

This short podcast talks about the life of Robert Moffat.

∞ Link: Five Minutes in Church History Podcast

WEEK 6 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 6

Hudson Taylor

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

"Hudson Taylor was born in Yorkshire, England, in 1832. His father was a pharmacist as well as a Methodist lay preacher who instilled in his son a passion for missions. Before he had reached his fifth birthday, the child was telling visitors that he wanted to some day be a missionary, and China (through the influence of his father) was the land that intrigued him the most." "His sights were set on reaching the whole of China, all 400 million people, and to that end he labored, though not single-handedly. He had a knack for organization, and he possessed a magnetic personality that drew men and women to him and to his point of view. The China Inland Mission was his creation and was a model for future faith missions. In his own lifetime the missionary force under him grew to more than eight hundred, and in the decades following his death it continued to expand." (Ruth Tucker, From Jerusalem to Irian Jaya)

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of Maria and Hudson Taylor

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.143-150 "The gathering room" - "passing in 1905."
 2. ∞ PDF Link: Excerpt from Hudson Taylor Biography p.98-101 (end at "of Chinese dress.")
- This excerpt tells about the first time Hudson Taylor changed his appearance to fit into the Chinese culture. It comes from the biography J. Hudson Taylor: God's Man in China by his son and daughter-in-law. The excerpt will mention his queue, which is a braid of hair usually worn hanging at the back of the head. It begins in the middle of a chapter when Hudson is traveling with a fellow missionary Dr. Parker, and they are

• IMPORTANT DATES

1865 - Hudson Taylor founds the China Inland Mission

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

looking for a place to set up a mission base. Dr. Parker gets called to minister and work at a hospital in another village, but Hudson is left alone to figure out where to go next and to find a place to rent.

- Hudson Taylor mirrored the method and motive of the Apostle Paul, who testified in 1 Corinthians 9:20: "To the Jews I became like a Jew, to win the Jews. To those under the law I became like one under the law (though I myself am not under the law), so as to win those under the law..." What do you think about his method of dressing and looking like a Chinese person in order to reach them for the gospel? What would be the benefits, and what might be some objections?

WEEK 7 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 7

Fact Files: The Gospel in Difficult Places

 Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

Today you will learn about two figures from church history that spend their life preaching the gospel in unique ways. The first man is mostly unknown to most people, but the second man was one of the most famous people in America at that time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.151-152 "You don't have" - "Apostle of Greenland."
 2. Listen (or read) more about Hans Egede.
- ∞ Audio Link: Hans Egede Story (can end at 5:44)

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

1. p.152-153 "Although we have" - "Asbury's tireless efforts."
 2. Watch this video that tells about the impact of Asbury in America in the 19th century.
- ∞ Video link: Francis Asbury (can end at 7:00)

WEEK 8 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 8

Fact Files: The Gospel in Difficult Places

 Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

You will read about two more individuals who brought the message of Christ into "difficult landscapes."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.153-155 "Although Soren Kierkegaard" - "one already lives."

→ VIEW

In this video, theologian R.C. Sproul talks through one of Kierkegaard's philosophical concepts.

∞ Video Link: Kierkegaard and the Leap of Faith (5:00)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.155-157 "While Kierkegaard stayed" - "wisdom, and humility."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Image of David Griffiths

Church History: Grades 7-9

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Term 1

WEEK 9 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 9

Dwight Moody

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

"Except for two twentieth-century evangelists, Billy Sunday and Billy Graham, no American has had the privilege of personally presenting the gospel of Jesus Christ to so many people. Indeed, by the time of D.L. Moody's death in 1899, the secretary of the International Committee of the Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA) declared that 'Mr. Moody delivered the gospel message in a larger number of places, to a larger number of persons, a larger number of times than any man who ever lived.'" (Lyle Dorsett, *A Passion for Souls*) Perhaps you have never heard of D.L. Moody, but he has impacted many lives, and his impact continues through the college Moody Bible Institute in Chicago, Illinois.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.159-167 "The four men" - "all things easy."

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Our Founder: D.L. Moody

WEEK 10 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 10

Bible Translation

Materials: Links

→ INTRO

If the Bible had never been translated into English, would you be able to read and understand God's message of salvation? We read about many different missionaries who translated the Bible into the native language of the people. Translation work continues to this day. Here are the latest statistics from Wycliffe Bible Translators (wycliffe.org.uk/statistics/): **1 in 5 people** are still waiting for the Bible in their language, **7,393** languages in the world, **3,248** languages have no Scripture—yet (down 20 from last month).

Today you will watch videos about Bible translation and how technology is speeding up the translation process in unprecedented ways.

→ VIEW

- ∞ Video Link: Translating for Understanding
- ∞ Video Link: Church-Led Bible Translation in the Pacific
- ∞ Video Link: Solving the Technical Challenges

(Optional) You can explore the Wycliffe Translators website to learn more about Bible translation in different regions.

∞ Link: Global Overview

- What did you learn about Bible translation that you didn't know before?
- How has technology helped the process?
- What questions do you still have about it?

WEEK 11 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 11

Catch-Up Day

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 12 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Renewal: The Church Expands Outward	
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Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 13

The Boy and the Books

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, Book of Centuries

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading last time in Church History?

→ INTRO

The next book we will be reading in Church History is a biography about Charles H. Spurgeon. Born in 1834, Spurgeon was a pastor and author who lived a life of faithful ministry. His devotional writings are still read by many today. You may put the date of Spurgeon's birth into your book of centuries.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.3-12 "I would rather" - "as a barn."

Optional: "Conditions in England During Spurgeon's Time" p.xv-xvii

• IMPORTANT DATES

June 19, 1834 - Charles H. Spurgeon born

WEEK 2 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 14

Conversion & Joy in Serving

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.15-27 "In the summer" - "had been baptized."

• On p.21 the author makes a statement that reads like a thesis statement or main point of what will be coming in the book: "The failure of preachers he had heard to present the gospel, and to do so in a plain, direct manner, caused him throughout his whole ministry to tell sinners in every sermon and in a most forthright and understandable way how to be saved." How do you think having this goal or idea in mind helped Spurgeon in his ministry? As we continue reading the biography of his life, note in what ways he stays consistent with this important point in his ministry.

WEEK 3 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 15

The Boy Preacher

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.28-29 "Nearly four months" - "begin to preach."

p.31-40 "In the summer" - "Church in London."

• The author divides the book into four main parts, with today's reading closing out the first part of the book. What are three main events from these early years of Spurgeon's life that stood out to you that seem to be preparing him for a life of ministry?

Church History: Grades 7-9

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Term 2

WEEK 4 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 16

Called to Be a Pastor

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, Book of Centuries

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.43-53 "A man named" - "did them part."

→ VIEW

Image Resource: Spurgeon: A Biography - images located after p.87
View the first four pages of pictures in your book (located after p.87).
Look at the image of Spurgeon at the age of 20 (around the time of being called as a pastor). Do you think those who put him down for his young age had a point? Why or why not?

• IMPORTANT DATES

April 1854 - Begins pastorship in London at the age of 19

WEEK 5 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 17

Charles and Susannah

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, Book of Centuries

NOTE: We will skip chapter 7 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.55-62 "Although most boys" - "made in heaven."
p.77-81 "For three years" - "salvation of souls."

→ VIEW

Image Link: Charles and Susannah at a Young Age
Image Link: The Crystal Palace
View the images at the links to see Charles and Susannah at a young age and the Crystal Palace in London.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Jan. 8, 1856 - Charles and Susannah Married

WEEK 6 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 18

The Church Grows

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

NOTE: Today's reading is a bit shorter. Use any extra time to catch up on reading or to read the article at the link.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

Spurgeon placed importance on prayer and on the people who were attending his church. Their conversion was a deep desire of his heart. The church he led put into place some ways of following up with those who professed salvation and who wanted to be members. As you read, consider how these ideas would work in a modern church today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.81-87 "His was a" - "great Metropolitan Temple."

• Do you think any of the ideas the church implemented to follow up with those who wanted to be members were helpful? Would any of those ideas work in a modern church? Why or why not?

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ OPTIONAL: READ THE LINKED ARTICLE CONTAINING A VISITOR'S EXPERIENCE HEARING SPURGEON PREACH.

∞ Article Link: What It Was Like to Hear Charles Spurgeon Preach

→ VIEW

Take some time to look at the rest of the images included in the book (located after p.87). What do you notice?

WEEK 7 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 19

The Metropolitan Tabernacle

📖 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, Book of Centuries

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

The Metropolitan Tabernacle would be the church where Spurgeon would spend the rest of his days as a preacher. In today's reading, he will also speak to a record-setting crowd of 23,654 at The Crystal Palace, the place he and Susannah had spent so much time. Imagine speaking - with just your voice! - to that large a crowd!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.91-99 "Spurgeon had been" - "called him home."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Metropolitan Tabernacle

The link shows the Metropolitan Tabernacle in more recent times. The Tabernacle is still active as a church to this day, although it has had to be rebuilt twice, once due to a fire and then after a bombing during World War II. It has a slightly different design to its front after its latest rebuild.

• IMPORTANT DATES

March 31, 1861 - First Sunday Service at the Metropolitan Tabernacle

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Spurgeon's Fast-Day Sermon
Read the sermon Spurgeon preached to the record-setting crowd at The Crystal Palace.

WEEK 8 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 20

The Pastors' College

📖 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

The next couple of chapters start to show the growth of Spurgeon's ministry outside of his pastorate. First, a college is started to train young pastors.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10 p.101-109 "During Spurgeon's first" - "for needy children."

WEEK 9 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 21

New Ways of Reaching the Community

📖 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

NOTE: Parts of this chapter will be skipped for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.111-113 "In 1865 Spurgeon" - "build God's work."

p.115-122 "But though Spurgeon" - "days on earth."

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- The church began reaching out into the community by publishing a magazine, printing sermons, and building new churches. In what ways is the message of the gospel spread by the church you attend? Are any of those ways similar to what the Metropolitan Tabernacle used? What new (modern) ways does your church use to reach the surrounding community?

WEEK 10 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 22

Widows & Orphans

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.125-130 "Dr. John Rippon" - "HIM BE GOD."

p.133-137 "From the late" - "of the gout."

James 1:27: "Religion that is pure and undefiled before God the Father is this: to visit orphans and widows in their affliction, and to keep oneself unstained from the world."

- Based on today's reading and the verse above, do you agree or disagree with the author's statement that "The orphanage was a lasting demonstration of the fact that Spurgeon's faith was not mere theory but that it produced good works" (p.130)? Why or why not?

WEEK 11 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 23

Mrs. Spurgeon

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

Charles Spurgeon's wife Susannah was a big part of his ministry, and today's chapter brings her work into the picture. Mrs. Spurgeon suffered from a medical illness that kept her from traveling or even attending church services for much of her adult life. However, today's reading will show how God brought together her unique abilities to minister to others and enabled her to have an impact on many.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.137-150 "Of this attack" - "and comfort others."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Susie Spurgeon

WEEK 12 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Spurgeon: A Biography

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 25

The Lively Church

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.153-161 "The Metropolitan Tabernacle" - "it all about."

WEEK 2 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 26

Books

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, Spurgeon's library of 12,000 books is mentioned. Spurgeon felt it was imperative that those who were teaching the Bible be learned and readers of books. In fact, he gave two pieces of advice about books to students: 1. Buy a few, high-quality books; 2. "Master those books you have." "Read them thoroughly," he wrote. "Bathe in them until they saturate you. Read and re-read them, masticate them, and digest them. Let them go into your very self. Peruse a good book several times, and make notes and analyses of it. A student will find that his mental constitution is more affected by one book thoroughly mastered than by twenty books which he has merely skimmed, lapping at them, as the classic proverb puts it 'As the dogs drink of Nilus.'"

He is also quoted as having said, "Visit many good books, but live in the Bible." As time allows, view the extra helping link to see a tour of a library that now holds half of his collection of books, including a commentary on Psalms from 1476.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16 p.163-175 "Between 1875 and" - "of the work."

EXTRA HELPING

View the video at the link to see the library where 6,000 of Spurgeon's books are kept. Begin at 17:20-24:05.

∞ **Video Link:** Spurgeon's Library Tour

WEEK 3 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 27

Spurgeon's Character

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17 p.177-188 "So pronounced a" - "to your souls."

WEEK 4 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 28

Spurgeon As An Author

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.18 p.191-201 "From the time" - "an unexampled degree."

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Optional: Read the linked passage from Spurgeon's Morning and Evening Devotional book.

∞ Link: Morning and Evening Devotional

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: The Sword & The Trowel

View the link to see the magazine published by Spurgeon, "The Sword & The Trowel."

WEEK 5 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 29

Controversy

📖 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

There are two parts to your reading today. First, read the assigned pages in the biography of Spurgeon that discuss a controversy that came up. There was a movement called Higher Criticism that moved through churches in the mid-1800s. This movement caused people to have a lower view of the Bible, which Spurgeon was highly motivated to argue against. After reading the pages in the book, read the linked sermon that Spurgeon spoke during this time. You may split the sermon reading between this week and next week to fit the time allotted.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19 p.205-209 "The Metropolitan Tabernacle" - "their firm opposition."

∞ Link: Poverty and Riches Sermon by Spurgeon

If needed, the sermon may be divided between this week and next week's lesson time.

WEEK 6 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 30

Glory Dwelleth in Immanuel's Land

📖 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

NOTE: A few pages are skipped at the beginning of the chapter for time's sake. Assigned pages are listed below.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

Toward the end of his life, Spurgeon experienced much physical pain and sickness. However, he held tight to his faith and looked forward to being with his Savior.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.224-233 "He found relief" - "is far better."

∞ Link: Poverty and Riches Sermon by Spurgeon

Complete your reading of the sermon if needed.

• IMPORTANT DATES

January 31, 1892 - Charles H. Spurgeon Dies

WEEK 7 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 31

Spurgeon's Funeral

📖 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

Church History: Grades 7-9

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Term 3

The final chapter of the book covers Spurgeon's funeral.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.234-244 "At the close" - "Charles Haddon Spurgeon."

- In the first lesson on the biography of Spurgeon, we noted the author makes a statement that reads like a thesis statement or main point of what Spurgeon strived to keep in mind when telling others about the gospel (p.21): "The failure of preachers he had heard to present the gospel, and to do so in a plain, direct manner, caused him throughout his whole ministry to tell sinners in every sermon and in a most forthright and understandable way how to be saved." Now that you have read more on Spurgeon, do you think he was able to remain faithful to this goal or aim of his ministry? How?

WEEK 8 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 32

Materials: An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

→ INTRO

This is the story of Pandita Ramabai who was born in India in 1858. She tells the story of her childhood, her hardships, and coming to faith in Christ. She also translated the Bible into Marathi so the uneducated women of lower castes could read the Bible. She has a remarkable story of how the light of the gospel found her in the darkest places.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Photo of Pandita and her daughter

→ BACKGROUND

India's caste system divides Hindus into four main categories—Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas, and the Shudras. Many believe that the groups originated from Brahma, the Hindu God of creation. At the top of the hierarchy were the Brahmins, who were mainly teachers and intellectuals and believed to have come from Brahma's head. Then came the Kshatriyas, or the warriors and rulers, supposedly from his arms. The third slot went to the Vaishyas, or the traders, who were created from his thighs. At the bottom of the heap were the Shudras, who came from Brahma's feet and did all the menial jobs. The main castes were further divided into about 3,000 castes and 25,000 sub-castes, each based on their specific occupation.

Outside of this Hindu caste system were the achhoots—the Dalits or the untouchables. (from bbc.com)

Pandita's family was part of the Shudra caste—the one at the bottom that did the menial jobs.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Basics of Hinduism

→ LOCATE

Find the Western Ghats. They are a mountain range that stretches 1000 miles along the coast of India. This is where Pandita was born.

∞ Map Link: Map of India

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

An Honorable Heritage p.1-6

→ BACKGROUND

The doctrine of *karma* is the backbone of the religious and social system of Hinduism. *Karma* says that whatever someone has—whether physical appearance, financial status, personality, health, or sorrow—is a result of his past life. One goes through the cycle of reincarnation based on his

• DEFINITIONS

Sanskrit: the sacred language of Hinduism

Vedas: a collection of poems or hymns composed in archaic Sanskrit that tell about Hindu teachings

Puranic literature: a vast genre of Hindu literature that includes a wide range of topics, especially legends and other traditional lore

Pandit: a teacher of any field of knowledge in Hinduism

penance: atonement for intentional and unintentional misdeeds

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

dharma in a previous life. If someone gives himself to vice and moral degeneration, he will not be destroyed or cease to exist. Rather, he will continue in the cycle of reincarnation—as long as necessary—until his soul reaches nirvana and he becomes one with the Ultimate Reality. If someone lives a life of bad *dharma*, he will be reborn in a lower caste or as a lower life form in the next cycle. (from Ligonier Ministries)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

A Unique Education; Famine, Death and Doubts p.7-19

- How had the beliefs of Hinduism negatively impacted Pandita and her family?

WEEK 9 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 33

Materials: An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

→ RECAP

Briefly recap what you read last time.

→ BACKGROUND

During the Vedic Period of northern India, the cow was a symbol of wealth and prosperity, as well as one of the animals offered in ritual religious sacrifices. But over time, possibly through the influence of Buddhism and Jainism, animal sacrifices waned, and the cow emerged as a sacred symbol to Hindus. The five products of the cow—milk, curds, butter, urine, and dung—are used in purifying and healing rituals. One popular Hindu god, Krishna, spent his early life as a cowherd, further elevating the status of the cow. In some states of India, there are bans and strict regulations concerning the slaughter of cows and the eating of beef. Many rules concerning food govern a Hindu's life—when to eat, what to eat, and who can prepare food for whom. The preparation and consumption of food are central to a Hindu's notion of ritual purity and, ultimately, their liberation from rebirth. Not all Hindus are vegetarians, but vegetarianism is seen as an indicator of purity. Many high-caste Hindus are vegetarians. (from International Mission Board)

→ LOCATE

Find Kolkata (formerly Calcutta). It is in the eastern part of India.
∞ Map Link: Map of India

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Introduction to Christianity; Calcutta; Marriage and Life in Bengal; Widowhood and Poona p.21-42

- Describe some of the inconsistencies Pandita was noticing about Hinduism and the Brahmo religion.

• DEFINITIONS

sahib: term used by some people in India to address or refer to a man in a position of authority. Sahib was used especially for government officials during the period of British rule.

amalgamate: merge into a single body

Upanishads: the most recent addition to the Vedas

Bengali: second-most spoken language in India

WEEK 10 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 34

Materials: An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

→ RECAP

Briefly recap what you read last time.

→ BACKGROUND

In the middle of the 19th century, a spiritual revival known as the Oxford Movement began in the Church of England. Those involved came to be known as Anglo-Catholics whose aim was to recall the Church of England to its origins and to restore reverence and beauty in worship. Out of the Oxford Movement came the first religious orders to be founded since

• DEFINITIONS

Svarga: a set of celestial worlds where the Hindu deities live and those who have led righteous lives can delight in pleasures, before their next birth on earth

• EXTRA HELPING

Read about the beliefs of Hinduism and how it differs from Christianity.

∞ **Article Link:** What is Hinduism?

Church History: Grades 7-9

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Henry VIII of England dissolved the monasteries in 1536. The Community of St Mary the Virgin was one of the first religious orders founded at this time in 1848, in Wantage, England. A religious order consists of members who lead a contemplative lifestyle devoted to prayer and service. There were branches in India, which is where Pandita first met them.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

England: Being Drawn to the Religion of Christ, Finding Christ p.43-68

- What were some of the differences between Hinduism and Christianity that initially drew Pandita to accept Christianity?
- Why do you think she still felt like something was missing when she first believed the doctrines of Christianity?
- How did everything change for her when she came to know Christ personally as her Lord and Savior?

WEEK 11 **30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 35**

Materials: An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

→ **RECAP**

Briefly recap what you read last time.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Telling Others, Bombay, Glorious New Hope, Unexpected Visit from the Governor, A Loving Invitation p.69-106

- Why do you think it would be hard for Hindus to become Christians?
- What part of Pandita's message in these chapters has stood out to you?

• **EXTRA HELPING**

Check out the Operation World website to learn how you can pray for the people of India.

∞ **Link:** India-Operation World

WEEK 12 **30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 36**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

Church History: Grades 7-9

Examination

- Term 1** · Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward: Tell all you know about a person from church history that you read about this term and how their life and mission impacted others.
- Term 2** · Spurgeon: A Biography: Tell about what you have learned of Charles Spurgeon's life and ministry over this term of reading.
- Term 3** · An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words: Tell all you know about Pandita's journey from being born into a Hindu family to later becoming a Christian. How did her beliefs and life change when she put her faith in Christ?